developed an abiding interest in statistics. In 1931, keen to develop knowledge in this new field in India, he founded the Indian Statistical Institute. Mahalanobis would devise new ways of studying large amounts of data, and go on to use statistical methods to study India's resources and economy. A key member of the Planning Commission, Mahalanobis's statistical analyses were used to plan India's economy, as well as conduct large-scale surveys to assess the country's production capabilities. He also established the National Sample Survey to collect social and economic data over time. This survey continues to be conducted today.

VERGHESE KURIEN

1921–2012



Born in Kerala to wealthy Syrian Christian parents, **Verghese Kurien** qualified as an engineer in India before winning a government scholarship to study in the US. When he returned in 1949, he was sent to work at a government creamery in Anand, Gujarat. Anand had a cooperative of milk producers who had tried to cut out middlemen in order to sell their milk